

Indian market. There is a marked shift in the way we do business now. Indian organisations are looking for a much more scalable platform, through which they can increase operational efficiency as well as deliver the desired result in a short turnaround time.

Q Why should enterprises go in for a software-defined data storage model in today's world?

The amount of unstructured data that floods an organisation's data centre is just too high to ignore. And for businesses that continue to rely on traditional proprietary storage, this indeed is a nightmare.

Software defined data storage has long been hailed as the panacea for all such enterprise storage woes. It isn't a new concept, but the ability to separate the storage software from the hardware is a game-changing innovation.

New architectures like Ceph-based storage solutions can scale infinitely without the need to refresh the entire platform or disrupt the existing functioning environment. Ceph uses intelligent algorithms to store data in a highly distributed manner. This means that it can optimise system performance without the need for teams of administrators to monitor and manage the storage constantly. Ultimately, with the data deluge and shrinking storage budgets, the future of storage is indeed going to be open source.

Q What are the major obstacles in the present SDS space?

There aren't any particular challenges when it comes to adoption. But there may be a lack of the economies of scale generally associated with the cloud. Many SDS providers claim that they provide the data centre with a cloud-like hyper-converged architecture. But in reality, only a few provide cloud-like models.

Q Where do microservices stand in the ever-growing IT sector in India?

Apart from DevOps and containers,

microservices have been gaining popularity in the IT sector recently. Microservices is not an entirely new idea, but the concept is fresh. It can play a crucial role in the current, dynamically challenging business environment by helping companies to better align their businesses and IT needs.

Basically, microservices is a combination of several smaller services, or simply, a suite of small services, where each service has a well-defined boundary and all services are interfaced through the API. This new approach enforces a level of modularity, making the individual services run faster to develop, test and deploy. Even developers get the added benefit as they only need to focus on a single service, rather than the entire monolithic application, which is easy to understand and maintain.

Q Is it only the increase in cloud adoption that has started pushing microservices, or is there an intrinsic interest among developers to begin with microservices?

I don't think that it is only one or the other that has increased the adoption of microservices. Both the cloud and the intrinsic interest among developers has led to this. The cloud provides an easy-to-deploy option without getting into capital expenditure.

Q What do you feel about the Indian government's interest in open source?

Undoubtedly, India is one of the biggest users and contributors to open source technology. It has come a long way and has evolved tremendously in the past few years—from viewing open source as just a cost-efficient alternative to proprietary solutions, to an imperative technology in the government's flagship 'Digital India' programme. Besides, the digital transformation has increased the adoption of open source both by enterprises and the government, across the country.

Today, digitisation, digitalisation and digital transformation are the three key words governing business environments at different levels for different industries. For IT-ITeS organisations, digital transformation is one of the most demanding roles that the CIO must play. The government sector, on the other hand, is witnessing a combination of digitisation and digitalisation. In the BFSI (banking, financial services and insurance) space, it is more about digitalisation and then embracing digital transformation through marketing to ensure that the bank reaches out to its end consumers through all possible ways.

Considering the volume of data that the government needs to deal with, open source is the only scalable and robust platform that can ensure a better result. Another aspect that goes in favour of open source is 'interoperability'. The government's infrastructure and systems need to support multiple systems, standards, applications and processes, which is possible only through the adoption of open technologies. Open source can be run on mainframes or desktops, without compromising on performance or quality. The government, as a customer, also appreciates freedom of choice—the biggest advantage of open source.

Q What are your views on the government's open source policy? Is it beneficial for open source providers in any way?

The government has a well-defined open source policy. Yes, as the technology space continuously changes, it is the responsibility of open source organisations like us to contribute and enable the government to adapt to the changes in the landscape.

Q Lastly, what's next at SUSE to attract enterprises to open source in India and across the world?

Our software defined storage and Container-as-a-Service are the next two attractions for global enterprises. 